

Problem 6:
You need to clean
consistently

546 categories?

- Inconsistency of category description is a common challenge in FOI responses
- How do you get 546 categories down to... 12?

Pure vibe coding fail 2

Codex/Claude Code given 2 lookup files + 29 CSVs of clean responses OR list of 570 categories

Accuracy (matching the hybrid approach) ranged from **35%** (Codex with CSVs) to **53%** (Claude with list)

Triage by problem — again!

1. Mixed data (code and category; category and Act/Section)
 - a. Text to columns
 - b. XLOOKUP function
2. Acronyms (e.g. GBH = “Grievous bodily harm”)
3. Upper/lower case
 - a. LOWER or PROPER function (use IF+UPPER/REGEXMATCH to identify all-caps entries)
4. Extra/analogous characters: quotation marks, spaces, apostrophes, commas, “and”/“&”, currency symbols
 - a. Find and replace or SUBSTITUTE function; TRIM; REGEXREPLACE
5. Different category level (top level, sub-category, lower level)
 - a. XLOOKUP function; COUNTIF to identify keywords > manual assignment to category
6. Slight variations
 - a. Sort and manual edits; Open Refine: cluster and edit

Category in 29forces data
"Public fear, alarm or distress"
"Racially or religiously aggravated public fear, alarm or distress"
Absconding from lawful custody
Action Fraud
Administering poison with intent to injure or annoy
Affray
Affray - Public Order Act 1986. Sec 3
Aggravated burglary business & community
Aggravated vehicle taking
Aggravated vehicle taking (driving / being carried) offences causing damage to vehicle and / or property under £5000
All other theft offences
Arrange or facilitate travel of another person with a view to exploitation
Arrange or facilitate travel of another person with a view to exploitation - Modern Slavery Act 2015 Sec 2 (1) & 5 (1)
Arson
Arson & Criminal Damage
ARSON AND CRIMINAL DAMAGE
Arson endangering life
Arson endangering life - Criminal Damage Act 1971 Sec 1
Arson not endangering life

Identify the destination — again!

- Find a table of **top level categories** you want to use for all responses
- Find **lookup tables** that
 - **map sub-categories** to top level categories
 - **map old categories** to new categories

Offence Code	Offence description	Old PRC offence group	Old offence sub-group	New ONS offence group	New ONS sub-offence group
56	Arson	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Arson
56A	Arson endangering life	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Arson
56B	Arson not endangering life	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Arson
58B	Criminal damage to a building other than a dwelling	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Criminal damage
58A	Criminal damage to a dwelling	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Criminal damage
58C	Criminal damage to a vehicle	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Criminal damage
58D	Other Criminal damage	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Criminal damage
58J	Racially or religiously aggravated Criminal damage	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Criminal damage
58F	Racially or religiously aggravated Criminal damage to a building other than a dwelling	Criminal damage		Criminal damage and arson	Criminal damage

Home Office code	Class	Sub class	Offence category	Offence	Act
056/01	Arson and Criminal Damage	Arson	56A Arson endangering life	Arson endangering life	Criminal Damage Act 1971
056/02	Arson and Criminal Damage	Arson	56B Arson not endangering life	Arson not endangering life	Criminal Damage Act 1971
057/00	Arson and Criminal Damage	Criminal damage	58A Criminal Damage - Residential	Criminal damage to a residence endangering life	Explosive Substance Act 1883 Sec 2,3 Criminal Damage Act 1971 Sec 1(2)
057/00	Arson and Criminal Damage	Criminal damage	58B Criminal Damage to a building - Business and Community	Criminal damage to a building business and community endangering life	Explosive Substance Act 1883 Sec 2,3 Criminal Damage Act 1971 Sec 1(2)
057/00	Arson and Criminal Damage	Criminal damage	58C Criminal Damage to a vehicle	Criminal damage to a vehicle endangering life	Explosive Substance Act 1883 Sec 2,3 Criminal Damage Act 1971 Sec 1(2)

Category in 29forces data	New ONS offence group
"Public fear, alarm or distress"	Public order offences
"Racially or religiously aggravated public fear, alarm or distress"	Violence against the person
Absconding from lawful custody	Miscellaneous crimes against society
Action Fraud	Fraud offences to 2012/13
Administering poison with intent to injure or annoy	Violence against the person
Affray	Violence against the person
Affray - Public Order Act 1986. Sec 3	Violence against the person
Aggravated burglary business & community	Theft offences
Aggravated vehicle taking	Theft offences
Aggravated vehicle taking (driving / being carried) offences causing damage to vehicle and / or property under £5000	Theft offences
All other theft offences	Theft offences
Arrange or facilitate travel of another person with a view to exploitation	Violence Against The Person
Arrange or facilitate travel of another person with a view to exploitation - Modern Slavery Act 2015 Sec 2 (1) & 5 (1)	Violence Against The Person
Arson	Criminal damage and arson
Arson & Criminal Damage	Criminal damage and arson
ARSON AND CRIMINAL DAMAGE	Criminal damage and arson
Arson endangering life	Criminal damage and arson
Arson endangering life - Criminal Damage Act 1971 Sec 1	Criminal damage and arson
Arson not endangering life	Criminal damage and arson

NotebookLM prompt: classify category levels

Based on the document CATEGORYLOOKUP.csv, classify what type of category you believe each force is using (class, subclass or offence).

Indicate a confidence level (high, medium, low)

Police Force	Category Type	Confidence Level	Evidence / Examples
Cumbria	Sub-class	High	Explicitly labels the data table as "Offence Sub Group," featuring categories like "Violence with Injury" and "Bicycle Theft".
Durham	Class	High	Provides broad Home Office groups such as "Violence Against the Person," "Drug Offence," and "Public Order Offence".
Greater Manchester	Sub-class	High	Uses a mix of specific groups like "Bicycle theft" and "Violence with injury," which fall under broader classes.
Hertfordshire	Class	High	Lists broad groupings in all caps, such as "VIOLENCE AGAINST THE PERSON" and "SEXUAL OFFENCES".
Humberside	Offence	High	Provides specific legal descriptions such as "BURGLARY RESIDENTIAL (UNCONNECTED BLDG)" and "AGGRAVATED VEHICLE TAKING".
Norfolk & Suffolk	Class	High	Reports data using the primary Home Office groups like "Theft," "Robbery," and "Violence Against the Person"